HERBALIFE - IIT MADRAS
CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE ON PLANT CELL FERMENTATION TECHNOLOGY

Inauguration Invitation

Chief Guests:
Dr. (Mrs.) N. Kalaiselvi, Director General, CSIR
Prof. V. Kamakoti, Director, IIT Madras

Special Guests:
Mr. Ajay Khanna, Managing Director, Herbalife International India Pvt. Ltd.
Prof. Ashwin Mahalingam, Dean (Alumni & Corporate Relations), IIT Madras

Monday, 22 June 2026

9:30 – 10:30 AM

TTJ Hall, ICSR, IITM

We warmly invite you to join us in celebrating this landmark occasion.
Your esteemed presence would greatly enrich the event.

Prof. Smita Srivastava
Head - Herbalife–IIT Madras CoE-PCFT
IIT Madras

Agenda

Inaugural Function

Herbalife–IIT Madras Centre of Excellence on Plant Cell Fermentation Technology

TTJ Auditorium • 22 June 2026 • 9:30 am onwards

Programme Schedule

9:00 – 9:30	Reception
9:30 – 9:40	Welcome Address
9:40 – 9:45	India's 1st COE on Plant Cell Fermentation Technology: An Audio-Visual Journey
9:45 – 10:15	Address by Chief Guests - **Dr. N. Kalaiselvi & Prof. V. Kamakoti** Address by Special Guests – **Mr. Ajay Khanna & Prof. Ashwin Mahalingam**
10:15 – 10:25	Inauguration and Curtain Raising Ceremony
10:25 – 10:30	Vote of Thanks – **Prof. Smita Srivastava**
10:30 – 11:00	High Tea
11:00 – 12:30	**Panel Discussion with Guests of Honour** • Commercial Plant Cell Fermentation: Global opportunities and outlook in the next decade • Regulatory Landscape for Fermentation-derived Herbal Products in India: Perspectives from Enablers and Engagers
12:30 – 13:30	Lunch Break
14:00 onwards	Visit of dignitaries to the COE Lab at IIT Madras Research Park

Herbalife - IIT Madras Centre of Excellence on Plant Cell Fermentation Technology

INDIA'S FIRST CoE on PLANT CELL FERMENTATION TECHNOLOGY

From Lab to Pilot Scale (TRL7)

The Herbalife–IIT Madras Centre of Excellence is India's first-of-its-kind facility dedicated to translational R&D in plant cell fermentation technology.

The Centre focuses on:

- Sustainable and scalable production of herbal biomass.
- Development of enriched herbal extracts and high-value phytochemicals.

By integrating advanced upstream cultivation systems with state-of-the-art downstream processing and metabolomic platforms, the CoE aims to:

- Enable technology transfer to industry
- Support capacity building in plant cell fermentation technology.
- Foster innovation and entrepreneurship in this emerging domain.

ENGINEERING THE FUTURE OF PLANT-DERIVED HEALTH & WELLNESS

CORE CAPABILITIES

UPSTREAM SYSTEMS

- Custom plant cell cultivation platforms.
- Controlled fermentation environments.
- Scalable bioprocess development.

DOWNSTREAM PROCESSING

- Extraction and purification pipelines.
- Enrichment of high-value phytochemicals.
- Quality and consistency assurance.

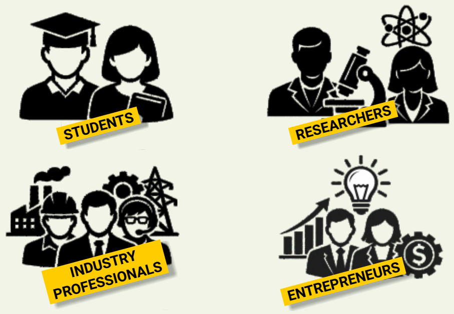
ANALYTICS & METABOLOMICS

- Advanced metabolomics platforms.
- Phytochemical profiling and characterisation.
- Data-driven process optimisation.

IMPACT & OUTCOMES

- Establishment of National and International academic-industry R&D partnerships.
- Skill development via student and faculty exchanges.
- IP creation and technology transfer to industry.
- Entrepreneurship and start-ups as spin-offs.
- Environmentally sustainable production and reduced import dependency.

STAKEHOLDERS



MODES OF ENGAGEMENT

ANALYTICAL SERVICES
Advanced analytics and metabolomics services for product development.

TECHNOLOGY TRANSFER
Licensing and transfer of validated technologies to industry.

SPONSORED RESEARCH
Collaborative research projects on plant cell fermentation and phytochemicals.

CONTRACT R&D
Problem specific R&D and customised solution development.

INDUSTRY CONSULTANCY
Expert guidance on bioprocess design, optimisation and scale-up.

PILOT-SCALE VALIDATION
Access to pilot-scale fermentation and process validation facilities.

STATE-OF-THE-ART FACILITIES

The COE is equipped with state-of-the-art instrumentation, including customized bioreactors for plant cell fermentation (15 and 75 L), Prep-HPLC, GC-MS/MS, High-pressure homogenizer, Supercritical Fluid Extraction, High-Speed Centrifuge, Tray Lyophilizer, and advanced research facilities.

CONTACT
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